

Back up your current BIOS

Ensure that the floppy drive is the first boot device in your BIOS settings. Insert the first floppy and reboot the system. You will taken to a DOS prompt (A:\) from where you should type in the name of the flash program. On the screen that appears, select the option to save your current BIOS to the first floppy disk where you only have the flash program. This will serve as a backup in case something goes wrong with your update and you need to revert to your old BIOS.

Flash the BIOS

Copy the flash program and the BIOS update file to the second floppy disk. Verify that the update file has been copied correctly. Reboot the system with the floppy inserted in the floppy drive. At the A:\ prompt, type out the name of the flash program followed by the BIOS update file name. A screen appears showing you the update file that will be flashed to the BIOS. Confirm it. *WAIT* will the BIOS is flashed. You will be informed when it is over and asked to exit. Once you are back

at the DOS prompt, remove the floppy and reboot the system. If everything has gone off well, you should get the normal POST screen.

Configure the new BIOS

After flashing your BIOS with new version and rebooting, enter the BIOS setup. The first step is to load the factory defaults (or the BIOS setup defaults—the terminology may vary depending on your BIOS). This will ensure

Flashing From Within Windows

Some motherboard vendors have started offering the option of flashing software that works under Windows. This is usually a program that is specifically designed to work the motherboard and BIOS of that system and makes the process of updating your BIOS much easier. Typically, the software will search the Internet for BIOS updates and guide you through the update process through a Wizard-like interface. This option is safer than the manual process, but only a few motherboard vendors provide this facility. So if you are shopping around for a new motherboard, you might want to consider this feature as one of your requirements.